



Imagine you're a tiny creature with a big, scary name like 'earwig'! These little fellows, often no more than an inch long, have a dark brown or black body that is long and slender. They have six legs and a pair of forceps-like pincers on their abdomen, which they use for defense and hunting. Despite their scary name, earwigs are quite harmless and their pincers aren't strong enough to harm a human.



Keeping their pincers busy, earwigs have a varied diet. They munch on a wide range of stuff, from plant debris and ripe fruits to other insects and their eggs. Because of their eating habits, they can be both helpful and harmful to gardeners. They aid in breaking down organic matter, but can also damage crops and ornamental plants.

From munching on plants and insects, let's jump to where these creatures call home. Earwigs are found almost everywhere around the world, but they prefer damp, cool places. They often hide in small, tight crevices during the day and come out at night to feed. You might find them under pots, in mulch, or amidst leaf piles in your garden.



insect world!

Now that we've visited their home, let's take a peek into their life cycle. Earwigs undergo incomplete metamorphosis, which means they pass through three stages: egg, nymph, and adult. Interestingly, they are one of the few non-social insect species that show maternal care. Mama earwigs guard their eggs and young until they are ready to fend for themselves, which is quite unique in the



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What color might the body of an earwig be?
A. black B. green C. red D. yellow
- 2) How big are earwigs?
A. half a foot in size B. no more than an inch long
C. tiny, like a grain of sand D. several feet long
- 3) Are earwigs deadly to humans?
A. Sometimes B. Yes C. Only male earwigs D. No
- 4) What is part of the diet of an earwig?
A. small rodents B. plant debris C. lumber wood D. walnuts
- 5) How is the maternal care of earwigs?
A. Mama earwigs eat their young
B. Mama earwigs guard their eggs and young
C. Mama earwigs leave their eggs alone
D. Mama earwigs build nests out of twigs for their young
- 6) What are the pincers of an earwig used for?
A. defense and hunting B. building nests
C. communication D. pollination
- 7) Where do earwigs prefer to live?
A. freezing places B. hot deserts
C. damp places D. grassy plains
- 8) When do earwigs come out to feed?
A. All the time B. In the morning C. In the afternoon D. At night
- 9) What is unique about the way earwigs care for their young?
A. The young earwigs take care of themselves.
B. Earwigs don't have young.
C. Mama earwigs guard their eggs and young.
D. Earwigs leave their young after they hatch.
- 10) What is the life cycle of an earwig called?
A. Adaptable metamorphosis B. Complete metamorphosis
C. Flexible metamorphosis D. Incomplete metamorphosis

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "I am a very big creature almost the size of a ruler."
- 12) "My mom doesn't only lay the eggs, she guards them and takes care of us until we can protect ourselves."
- 13) "I abandon my eggs and young ones as soon as they are laid."



- 14) "The moment I'm born, I start fendng for myself."
- 15) "Sometimes, I eat tiny insects or their eggs, a bit like a mini predator!"
- 16) "You can find my siblings and me in damp, cool spots, hiding in crevices during the day."
- 17) "I love hot, sunny places."
- 18) "I come out and feed during the day."
- 19) "Don't be fooled by my name, 'earwig', I'm not going to crawl into your ear."
- 20) "I'm pretty hard to spot. Usually I'm only about an inch long."
- 21) "I use my pincers to harm humans."
- 22) "You may find me in your garden, I enjoy munching on your plant debris and ripe fruits."
- 23) "I dislike damp places."
- 24) "I do a bit of both good and bad in gardens, I help breakdown stuff but I can damage some plants too."
- 25) "I'm not helpful to gardeners at all."
- 26) "I only eat other insects."
- 27) "You're unlikely to find me in your garden."
- 28) "I have a pair of forceps-like pincers on my abdomen, but they are not strong enough to hurt you."
- 29) "I am most active at night-time, crawling out of my hiding place to look for food."
- 30) "The interesting fact is, we earwigs are found almost everywhere on the planet."
- 31) "I start off as an egg, then turn into a nymph and finally into an adult like you see now."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 32) Earwigs can be found mostly in damp and cool places.
- 33) Earwigs are extremely scary because of their pincers.
- 34) Earwigs eat different things including plant debris, ripe fruits and other insects.
- 35) The long, slender bodies of earwigs are cool because they set them apart from other insects.
- 36) Earwigs are small, usually not more than an inch long.
- 37) Earwigs are creepy since they come out at night to feed.
- 38) Earwigs most often hide during the day and only come out at night to feed.
- 39) Earwigs have a pair of pincers on their abdomen that they use for defense and hunting.
- 40) It's impressive to see such small creatures like earwigs showing maternal care.
- 41) The variety of food that earwigs eat is something really interesting.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 42) Earwigs care for their young until they can fend for themselves.
- 43) Earwigs are usually found in dry places, like deserts.
- 44) Earwigs prefer damp and cool places to hide during the day.
- 45) Earwigs are usually between 5 and 6 inches long.
- 46) Earwigs prefer to live in damp places.
- 47) Earwigs can harm humans with their pincers.
- 48) Earwigs go through five stages in their life cycle: egg, nymph, cocoon, adult, and old age.
- 49) Earwigs only eat other insects.
- 50) Earwigs use their pincers for defense and hunting.



51) Earwigs can be helpful to gardeners.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

52) Earwigs won't hurt your garden.

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| A. will | B. will not |
| C. would not | D. do not |

53) Earwigs don't bite humans.

- | | |
|-----------|-----------|
| A. do not | B. won't |
| C. can't | D. aren't |

54) They're called earwigs, but they won't crawl into your ears.

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| A. were not | B. do not |
| C. cannot | D. will not |

55) Some earwigs have wings, but they usually don't use them.

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| A. do not | B. cannot |
| C. are not | D. will not |

56) Earwigs can't hurt humans, so there's no need to be afraid of them.

- | | |
|-----------|-------------|
| A. do not | B. are not |
| C. cannot | D. will not |

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

57) Earwigs don't actually crawl into people's ears, it's a common misconception!

58) Carefully observe the earwig's pincers when you see one.

59) Why are they called earwigs?

60) How incredible it is that earwigs can produce a foul-smelling liquid for defense!

61) Earwigs can be found in damp, dark places like under rocks, logs, or leaf piles.

62) Do earwigs like to live in moist and warm environments?

63) Earwigs are harmless to humans and can help keep pests away from our plants.

64) Are earwigs insects that have wings?

65) The name earwig comes from a myth that they crawl into people's ears while they sleep.

66) If you find an earwig in your garden, gently place it back in its natural habitat.

67) It's amazing how earwigs help to keep our gardens healthy by eating other insects and plants!

68) Share some fun facts about earwigs with your friends.

Determine which choice is the conclusion that can be drawn from the statement.

69) Despite their name, earwigs do not crawl into people's ears. Based on this statement, what conclusion can be drawn about earwigs?

- | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|
| A. All earwigs live in human ears. | B. The name 'earwig' is misleading. |
| C. Earwigs are named because of their ear-like pincers. | D. Earwigs are afraid of humans. |



- 70) Earwigs have pincers on their backs which they use to protect themselves from predators. Based on this statement, what conclusion can be drawn about earwigs?
- A. Earwigs use their pincers as a self-defense mechanism.
 - B. Earwigs use their pincers for climbing.
 - C. Earwigs use their pincers to attack other insects.
 - D. Earwigs are predators of many other insects.
- 71) Earwigs can be found all over the world except in the polar regions. Based on this statement, what conclusion can be drawn about earwigs' habitat?
- A. Earwigs inhabit only the polar regions.
 - B. Earwigs can live anywhere, even in extreme cold.
 - C. Earwigs can only be found in tropical regions.
 - D. Earwigs have a wide geographical distribution but cannot survive in very cold environments.
- 72) Earwigs are nocturnal and often hide in small, moist crevices during the day. Based on this statement, what conclusion can be drawn about earwigs?
- A. Earwigs are afraid of the dark.
 - B. Earwigs are diurnal and don't like moist environments.
 - C. Earwigs can't survive in dry environments.
 - D. Earwigs are active at night and prefer damp environments.
- 73) Mom earwigs protect their eggs and stay with them until they hatch. Based on this statement, what conclusion can we draw about how earwigs handle their offspring?
- A. Earwigs display parental care.
 - B. Earwigs only lay 1 or 2 eggs at a time.
 - C. Earwigs lay eggs and leave them to fend for themselves.
 - D. Earwigs don't care about their offspring.



Earwigs

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | 69. _____ |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | 70. _____ |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | 71. _____ |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | 72. _____ |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | 73. _____ |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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Earwigs

Name: _____

1.	A	26.	Not	51.	true
2.	B	27.	Not	52.	B
3.	D	28.	Would	53.	A
4.	B	29.	Would	54.	D
5.	B	30.	Would	55.	A
6.	A	31.	Would	56.	C
7.	C	32.	fact	57.	exclamatory
8.	D	33.	opinion	58.	imperative
9.	C	34.	fact	59.	interrogative
10.	D	35.	opinion	60.	exclamatory
11.	Not	36.	fact	61.	declarative
12.	Would	37.	opinion	62.	interrogative
13.	Not	38.	fact	63.	declarative
14.	Not	39.	fact	64.	interrogative
15.	Would	40.	opinion	65.	declarative
16.	Would	41.	opinion	66.	imperative
17.	Not	42.	true	67.	exclamatory
18.	Not	43.	false	68.	imperative
19.	Would	44.	true	69.	B
20.	Would	45.	false	70.	A
21.	Not	46.	true	71.	D
22.	Would	47.	false	72.	D
23.	Not	48.	false	73.	A
24.	Would	49.	false		
25.	Not	50.	true		